

designed to prevent criminal activities such as fraud and bribery, or the sale of faulty goods.

Businesses naturally want the freedom to act in their own best interests, or for the good of their companies and shareholders, but governments must act in the interest of the public, and the economy of the country as a whole. For instance, businesses see taxes as a burden, even though they provide governments with the money to sustain public services such as education and health care for those who couldn't afford to pay for them. In many countries, there are laws against unfair trading practices to protect the rights of consumers and to ensure workers get fair pay and working conditions.

Some economists believe governments should intervene to help the country's economy. One of the downsides of a free market is that it has spells of boom and bust. If a government has some control over the planning of its economy, it can minimize these fluctuations and maybe avoid a financial crisis. Some government intervention, such as taxes on imported goods, and subsidies for industries to help them to compete with foreign companies, can be beneficial to businesses, too.